

English 9
Smith/Marinaro
2026-2027

An introduction to the study of literature and academic writing, *English 9* provides students with the fundamentals necessary for advanced work in language arts, with an emphasis on the critical analysis (i.e., close reading) of fiction and informational texts, the awareness of different modes of writing—creative, argumentative, informative, and personal—and the development of speaking and listening skills.

Throughout the year, students will learn to locate textual evidence to support original ideas and to make inferences, considering the literary techniques and structural choices of authors. A variety of audio-visual media will supplement the core texts listed below. Written work will include a mix of informal and formal assignments, and all students will complete a research paper in the spring. In addition, students should expect to write journal entries, analytical paragraphs, literary essays, and creative works in response to classroom texts.

Independent reading plays an integral role in developing reading fluency. Students will be asked to read at least one independent reading title per quarter. Though all titles will ultimately be determined by student choice, there may be guidelines for particular genres that students will be expected to follow.

English 9 includes a comprehensive study of grammar and vocabulary. Through a series of regular mini-lessons, students will work to master the major rules of punctuation and usage. In addition, students will study 15 vocabulary lists, many of which are derived from the core literary texts they will encounter.

We use a standards-based grading system that measures student achievement on a scale of 1 to 4 (beginning to mastery). Only assessments designed to measure standards will be included in a student's overall grade.

Core Texts:

Selected short stories, poetry, and essays

Lorraine Hansberry's *A Raisin in the Sun* (1958), Drama (ISBN 978-0679755333)

William Golding's *Lord of the Flies* (1954), Fiction (ISBN 978-0399501487)

William Shakespeare's *Macbeth* (1606), Drama (ISBN 978-0486278025)

J.D. Salinger's *The Catcher in the Rye* (1945), Fiction (ISBN 978-0316769488)

Office Locations: Room 116 (Smith) & Room 310 (Marinaro)

Conferences: by appointment

Materials: pens, paper, highlighters, journal (provided), notebook, laptop, sticky notes

Email: dsmith@byramhills.net; jmarinaro@byramhills.net

Standards-Based Grading

We use a standards-based grading system that measures student achievement on a scale of 1 to 4 (beginning to mastery). Only assessments designed to measure standards will be included in a student's overall grade. Students will have multiple opportunities to demonstrate proficiency, and all quarterly grades will reflect both a student's current skill level and overall growth.

As a result, the percentages reported in the eSD Parent Portal will not be an accurate reflection of the student's overall grade; therefore, please refer to individual grades on assignments and the following conversion chart¹:

4-pt Avg		Numerical (eSD)
3.75-4.00	A+	93.75-100
3.00-3.74	A	75-93.74
2.84-2.99	B+	68.75-74.99
2.50-2.83	B	50-68.74
2.34-2.49	C+	43.75-49.99
2.00-2.33	C	31.25-43.74
1.00-1.99	D+	25-31.24
Below 1.00	F	0-24.99

¹ Adapted from Marzano (2010)